

Research Communication Writing Competition

Organized by Saryan Vigyan Foundation

About the Competition

How can research travel beyond academic journals and reach wider audiences? How can complex ideas about ecology, conservation and society be communicated through accessible, engaging writing?

The Western Himalayan Initiative for Landscape, Diversity and Ecologies invites students, young researchers and emerging science communicators to write an article that makes research accessible to a wider audience. The competition welcomes contributions from both natural and social sciences, with a focus on ecology, conservation and the relationships between people and their environments in the Western Himalayas.

There is no prescribed theme. Participants are encouraged to choose a subject they find compelling and explore how it can be communicated clearly, creatively and responsibly to readers beyond academia.

Rules and Guidelines

1. Subject

There is no fixed theme. Submissions must engage with research relevant to ecology, conservation or the relationships between society and the environment. Participants may draw on published research, their own research, scientific concepts, field observations or documented environmental issues.

2. Format

All submissions must be written as articles intended for a general, non-specialist audience. Articles may take the form of explainers, research-based features, narrative non-fiction, opinion pieces grounded in evidence, or creative articles that use fictional elements to communicate research or ecological concepts.

3. Word limit

Each article must be between **800 and 1,000 words**, inclusive of the title and article text but excluding references and the author's short biography. Submissions exceeding the word limit may be disqualified.

4. Originality and sources

Submissions must be original work. Participants must acknowledge all sources of information, research, data, quotations and ideas. A reference list or hyperlinks to credible sources must accompany the article. Previously published articles are not eligible.

5. Scientific and research integrity

Articles must represent research and evidence accurately. Participants should distinguish established findings from interpretation, opinion, uncertainty and speculation. Social science research, Indigenous and community knowledge, and lived experience should be represented with appropriate context and attribution.

6. Language

Articles may be submitted in English or Hindi. Where necessary, the organisers may arrange translation or use a common translation protocol for judging.

7. Submission

- Format: PDF or DOCX
- Word limit: 800–1,000 words
- Include a title, a brief author biography (up to 50 words) and references or source links.
- Submit via saryanfoundation@gmail.com by 30th october.

8. Use of AI tools

Participants must disclose any use of generative AI in developing their submission, including research assistance, drafting, editing, translation or image generation. Participants remain responsible for the accuracy, originality and integrity of their work.

9. Judging criteria

Submissions will be assessed on a 100-point scale:

- Accuracy and responsible use of evidence: 25 points
- Understanding of the subject and research: 20 points
- Accessibility and suitability for a general audience: 20 points
- Clarity and effectiveness of communication: 20 points
- Originality and engagement: 15 points

10. Copyright and publication

Participants retain copyright over their submissions. By entering, participants permit the organisers to contact them regarding possible publication or display. Any reproduction or publication will require the participant's permission and appropriate attribution.

11. Results

The winners will be selected by a judging panel appointed by the organisers. The judges' decision will be final. The organisers may withhold an award if submissions do not meet the required standards.

Submission deadline: 5th November 2026

Contact: saryanfoundation@gmail.com



Author Bio
Add a short bio of 50–75 words, including your academic affiliation, research interests or relevant experience.

Suggested file name: `YourName_ArticleTitle_Language.docx`

Please ensure that your article is within the word limit and that all sources are properly acknowledged before submission.

Suggested readings that participants may choose to work on:

https://doi.org/10.1002/2688-8319.12232

https://doi.org/10.1016/j.landusepol.2020.105041

https://www.nature.com/articles/s41598-026-46640-5

https://esajournals.onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/10.1002/eap.70031

https://esajournals.onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/10.1002/eap.70157